become far more difficult. Meanwhile, the Afghan jihad was thriving and thus impossible to ignore for a pan-Islamist outfit like Lashkar.

A small number of Lashkar members already were active in the Afghan insurgency by the middle of the decade when the group's organizational footprint on that front grew. Entrance into the Afghan theater necessitated a greater presence in the Tribal Areas and heightened collaboration with other militant outfits active there. Many of these actors were considerably more involved in Afghanistan than Lashkar while some were also at war with the Pakistani state. One consequence of the increased integration of Lashkar members with these other, sometimes more extreme, outfits was to put pressure on the leadership to expand the group's involvement in the global jihad against America and its allies. The 2008 Mumbai attacks were launched amidst this environment. They had multiple objectives, one of which was to harm the group's historic enemy. Another was to to boost Lashkar's reputation and integrate its war against India with the global jihad.

Anger at perceived American meddling in Pakistan and the occupation of Afghanistan, as well as alleged US favoritism toward India, were recurrent themes in every interview the author conducted with Lashkar members. These parochial concerns were viewed through the prism of a wider American-led 'war against Islam,' in which many Western countries were seen to take part. However, Lashkar's leaders did not intend the group's growing involvement in the global jihad against America and its allies to come at the expense of war against India. This policy of attempting to have it both ways opens the group up to splintering and factionalism, which are more common in larger organizations that embrace multiple causes than in smaller ones united behind a single objective. Indeed, Lashkar's leaders still face challenges to their legitimacy because they continue to prioritize the jihad against India when forced to choose. This has alienated some members, as have their leaders' close ties to the army and ISI and continued policy of abjuring attacks against the Pakistani state. The longer the insurgencies last in Afghanistan and Pakistan, the more difficult it may become to control the next generation of Lashkar militants. Yet it would be a mistake to presume the growing threat comes only from potentially rogue operatives; since the Mumbai attacks Lashkar, as an organization, has expanded the scope of its jihad even further.